



The ethos of THIIIRD is informed by decolonial and intersectional feminist thought. We believe in the potential of print and multimedia as a tool for (self-) affirmation and positive social change.’¹¹

Theories around ethnicity and postcolonial theory – Paul Gilroy

THIIIRD is informed by decolonial thought, developing Gilroy’s idea that colonial discourses still inform contemporary attitudes to race and ethnicity. THIIIRD embraces the 21st century idea of decolonisation, that there are many kinds of diasporic identities, all of which are valid and worthy of respect. Decolonising means unravelling the idea that there is only one ‘correct’ ethnocentric truth, recognising there are many lenses to look through. Instead of accepting a very narrow ‘traditional’ ideal of beauty or culture, decolonisation encourages us to pay attention to all the threads of heritage that form a narrative of our shared culture and past, all different. This democratisation of worth goes against the idea of civilisationism, where *‘identity is as much about difference as about shared belonging.’¹²* Decolonising our past allows us to hear a much more clamorous, chaotic, hybrid collection of all sorts of people who are welcomed into the group to have their say. You could compare this with other set products that discuss decolonialism, for example, **Have You Heard George’s Podcast?**

PART 3 STARTING POINTS: Media industries

Processes of production, distribution and circulation by organisations, groups and individuals in a global context.

As a small independent magazine, THIIIRD’s editorial team have to find their own funding for each issue of the magazine through a range of methods. Initially, Rhona and a partner invested their own savings to create

the first print issue. When they managed to successfully launch the magazine and recoup their money, they reinvested it for the next issue. The web magazine draws attention to the annual print edition, promotes THIIIRD’s events and podcast, and encourages the community of creatives and readers to buy the print magazine, and to contribute to it.

‘Print is definitely the holy grail, but the other channels we use are our podcast, social media, our online website and, in the regular world, events.’¹³

Although the print magazine is expensive to produce, the web magazine also carries a lot of costs, in terms of labour and office space, updating the website with current material, managing responses to questions, ideas for submissions and orders from the shop. 3000 editions are printed for each issue, and several have sold out. The magazine is available in stockists throughout the world, especially popular in New York and Amsterdam. Online outlets, such as Stack and magCulture, also sell the magazine and in this way publicise THIIIRD’s website. The print magazine is distributed by an established independent distribution company in Falmouth, Ra and Olly, who have been distributing indie magazines all over the world since Time Out in 1969.

Representations in the magazine reflect the people who own and run the magazine. Rhona Ezuma is editor-in-chief and she states on Instagram:

‘Our magazine is women-run and Black owned with an eclectic diverse team of creatives. We are making sure the voices of people of colour, trans, non-binary, queer individuals, women and all marginalised peoples are platformed on our space.’¹⁴

¹¹ THIIIRD manifesto <https://www.thiiirdmagazine.co.uk/about>

¹² Gilroy, 1993

¹³ <https://magculture.com/blogs/journal/rhona-thiiird>

¹⁴ THIIIRD Instagram post 11.4.2023